

receiver is in an important meeting or sleeping. To this end, Telegram allows users to send Silent Messages that will not make any sound or vibration even if the recipient hasn't turned on Do Not Disturb. Simply type your message, tap and hold the send button and now, choose 'Send without sound'.



ADD NEARBY PEOPLE

Telegram also has a pretty useful feature that allows you to find Telegram users and groups based on your location. It's a pretty nifty feature, from the security standpoint as well, since you then don't need to share your phone number to add someone. Additionally, if you are going to a certain event, you can add groups related to that event. To add nearby users or groups, open the Telegram hamburger menu and head to Contacts. Now, tap on 'Find People Nearby'. You will now see a list of people using Telegram near you as well as groups in the area.



SSH!

While normal Telegram chats have user-to-server encryption, you can take this one step further by enabling something called Secret Chats which provide user-to-user encryption, so they aren't even stored on Telegram's servers. To start a Secret Chat, you can either go to the hamburger menu and click on 'New Secret Chat' or you can go to an existing chat, click the person's profile icon and then click on the three-dot menu where you can find the 'Start Secret Chat' option. Once you have started the chat, the person on the other

end will have to accept your request for a Secret Chat.



SELF-DESTRUCTING CHATS AND IMAGES

Much like Signal, you can add a self-destruct timer for your chats. Unfortunately, this feature is only available in Secret Chats. Here, you can set a self-destruct timer for chats for a duration varying from one second to one week. Once the timer has ticked down, the chat will disappear for both parties. In a similar vein, you can also self-destruct media content you send to Telegram users, and not just within Secret chats. Simply select a photo or video to send to a contact and then tap on the timer button on the bottom of the screen



LOCK YOUR CHATS

Telegram not only provides end-to-end encryption for your chats but also allows users to lock them. This is great for when you're handing out your device to someone else. To lock a chat on Telegram, head over to Settings >



Add self destruct timers for images and videos in normal Telegram chats



You can use existing bots on Telegram, third-party bots, or even create your own bot

Privacy and Security. Now, navigate to Passcode Lock under the Security tab and simply toggle it on. You can unlock or lock chats by clicking the lock button on the top right side of the screen. Now, the Telegram app will prompt you to enter your passcode or use your biometrics to enter the app and access the chats.



USING BOTS

Telegram allows users to access a plethora of bots as per their need. To activate and use a bot, simply enter @ and the name of the bot you want to use. Examples of bots on Telegram include @gif which searches for GIFs, @vid to search for videos, @imdb to search for information about movies and TV shows, @bing for normal search, and others. You can also access third-party bots that allow you to accomplish other actions. Additionally, you can even create your own customised bots as per your requirements. You will need to get some help from @botfather which will guide you through the steps of creating a bot and setting up its tasks.



SET UP SLOW MODE FOR GROUP CHATS

If you're a group admin on

Telegram, you can enable Slow Mode on groups to stop unnecessary spam and make the conversation less chaotic. You can turn on Slow Mode by tapping on the group name in Telegram and then clicking the Edit (pen icon) button. Now, click on Permissions > Slow Mode. You can set the time restriction as per your requirement, so if you choose 10 seconds as the time interval in Slow Mode, groups members will only be able to send messages every 15 seconds, making group chats with a number of members more orderly.



SET TIMESTAMPS FOR VIDEOS

Just like we can share YouTube videos with pre-defined time stamps, Telegram allows you to send a video with a specific timestamp as well. All you need to do is select a video you want to share with a contact in the corresponding chat and then mention the timestamp in this format: 00:00. For example, you could ask someone to "Check out what happens at 1:40". Now, the timestamp becomes clickable and the recipient can simply click it to check what happens in that particular timestamp in the video. 📺